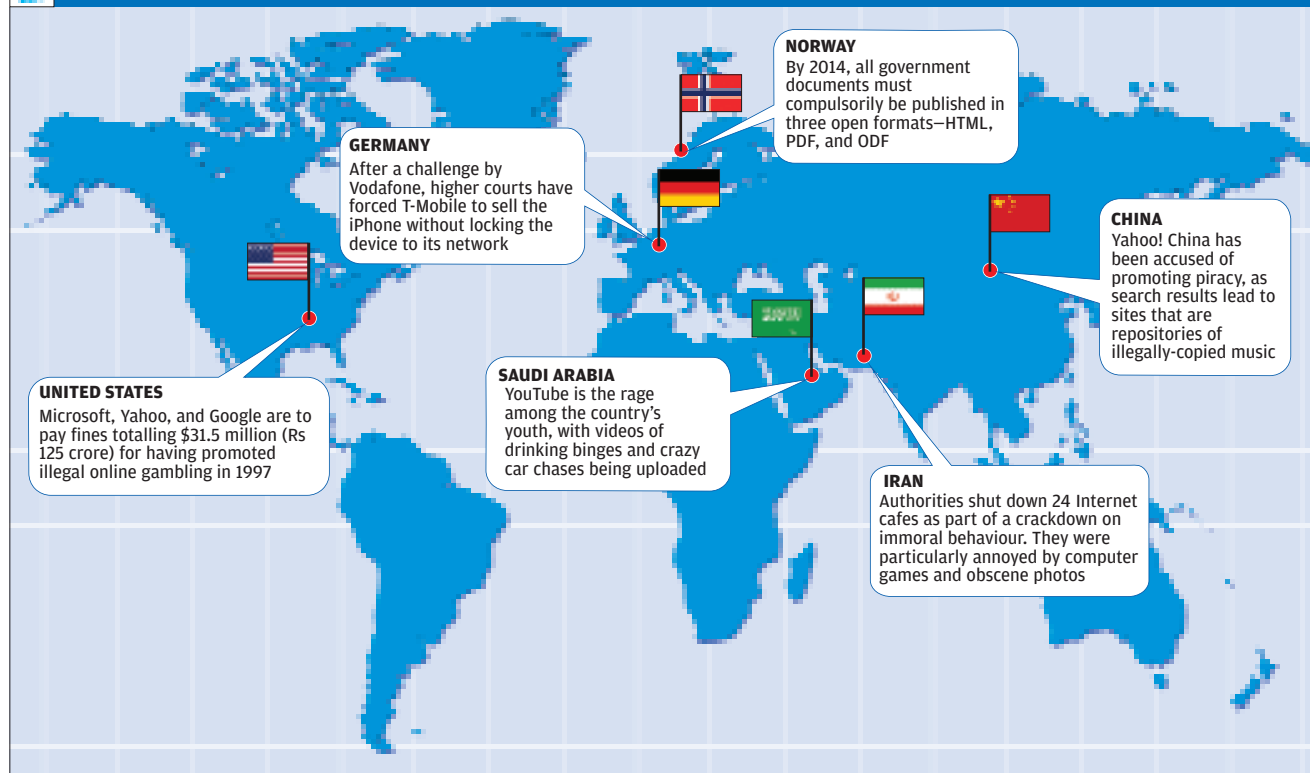


 The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe

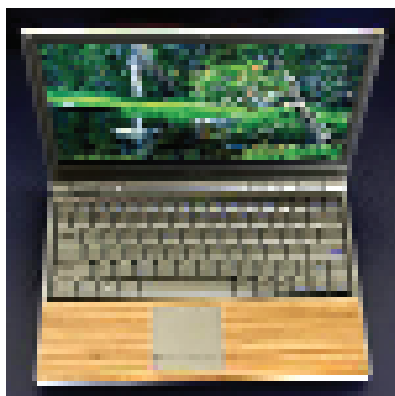
**GO GREEN—LITERALLY!****Bamboo Goodness**

Apple, which today sells sleek aluminium iMacs, started out with the Apple 1 in a wooden box. Manufacturers soon shifted to synthetic materials for casings, which were cheaper but turned out to be harmful to the environment. E-waste is a growing problem the world over, and is exacerbated by the rapid changes in hardware, which necessitates frequent upgrades.

ASUSTek Computer, which markets its products like notebooks and motherboards under the ASUS brand, has unveiled a laptop which, it hopes, will change the trend. The ASUS Eco Book, in the prototype stage, is encased in bamboo. Laminated strips cover all the surfaces of the prototype except for the keys, trackpad, and monitor.

For countries in South-East Asia, this environmentally-friendly laptop is a boon. Bamboo grows abundantly in this part of the world, and its rate of growth is way faster than that of a tree. With municipal landfills in developing countries chock-full of plastics and hazardous chemicals like the lead and arsenic used in computers, the demand for such green computers is likely to be huge. But these laptops are still not ready for prime time. The heat released from processors and monitors is a big concern, as are problems related to rough handling. These laptops are also not entirely green: the glues and laminates used for fortifying the bamboo might contain toxins.

Green computing has been a growing corporate trend. Manufacturers have been trying to make each and every component more eco-friendly—whether it's



chemicals used in fabricating cases, or the materials used in chips. Dell, Lenovo, Apple, and HP are all concentrating on cutting power wastage, recycling components, and improving efficiency. A laptop made from bamboo fits neatly into the scheme of things.

HACK ATTACK**Apple? And Security?**

The iPhone is undeniably hot. It's so hot that people have

stood for days in long queues to buy it, and its manufacturers have had to prevent people from buying more than five handsets. Now, though, the rock-star popularity of the iPhone might work to Apple's disadvantage in terms of increased security attacks.

Apple's operating systems have always had a reputation for solid security. While Apple and its legions of fans tout these as features, more neutral observers ascribe the seemingly hacker-proof features to a minuscule market share (single digits). Hackers and cyber-crooks simply do not get enough returns on their efforts.

With the release of the iPhone, Apple has come from niche to mainstream. And it's not only Apple's competitors that have noticed the surging sales: since the iPhone runs a full-blown Mac OS X 10.5, the iPhone is wide open to malicious attacks. With millions of iPhones in the market, volumes have become enough to justify serious attacks that would